

Child Growth and Development

Virtual Early Childhood Observation

Objectives

- ✓ To see early childhood development in action
- ✓ To identify milestones of development
- ✓ To examine influences on development
- ✓ To make connections to a theory of development
- ✓ To reflect on this experience

Before You Begin

Read this assignment completely, including the evaluation rubric. If you did not complete the Infant/Toddler Observation, please look at the examples provided in that assignment. If you did complete that observation, please look at the feedback your instructor provided as this and the following observation have similar requirements and will be graded on similar criteria. If you have questions about that feedback or this assignment and/or how it will be graded, reach out to your instructor for clarification.

Part One: Observing Two Preschoolers

Step A: Watch the Clip

Please watch the captioned [4:25 video clip Cameron and Alexis Playing with Blocks](#).

Step B: Observe for Developmental Milestones

Watch the video clip again and mark which of the milestones on the three checklists below that you were able to see for Cameron in the far left column. Remember that we are using the age before and after their age (they are both 4 years old) to capture a bigger picture of their development.

Watch it one last time and mark the milestones on the three checklists below that you were able to see for Alexis in second from the left column.

Use an X if you were able to actually observe the milestone. Use a ? if you think the child might be able to do this based on what you were able to see.

3-Years-Old Checklist

Here are the milestones most children can do by years of age

Cameron	Alexis	
Gross Motor		
?	?	Climbs well
?	?	Runs easily
?	?	Pedals a tricycle (3-wheeled bike)
?	?	Walks up and down stairs, one foot on each step
Fine Motor		
?	?	Copies a circle with pencil or crayon
?	?	Turns book pages one at a time

X	X	Builds towers of more than 6 blocks
		Screws and unscrews jar lids or turns door handle
Cognitive Milestones		
?	?	Can work toys with buttons, levers, and moving parts
X	X	Plays make-believe with dolls, animals, and people
?	?	Does puzzles with 3 or 4 pieces
X	X	Understands what "two" means
Language Milestones		
X	X	Follows instructions with 2 or 3 steps
X	X	Can name most familiar things
		Understands words like "in," "on," and "under"
?	?	Says first name, age, and sex
X	X	Names a friend
X	X	Says words like "I," "me," "we," and "you" and some plurals (cars, dogs, cats)
X	X	Talks well enough for strangers to understand most of the time
X	X	Carries on a conversation using 2 to 3 sentences
Social and Emotional Milestones		
?	X	Copies adults and friends
?	?	Shows affection for friends without prompting
		Takes turns in games
		Shows concern for a crying friend
X	X	Understands the idea of "mine" and "his" or "hers"
X	X	Shows a wide range of emotions
?	?	Separates easily from mom and dad
		May get upset with major changes in routine
?	?	Dresses and undresses self

4-Years-Old Checklist

Here are the milestones most children can do by 4 years of age

Cameron	Alexis	
Gross Motor		
		Hops and stands on one foot up to 2 seconds
		Catches a bounced ball most of the time
Fine Motor		
?	?	Pours, cuts with supervision, and mashes own food
?	?	Draws a person with 2 to 4 body parts
?	?	Uses scissors
?	?	Starts to copy some capital letters
Cognitive Milestones		
		Names some colors and some numbers
		Understands the idea of counting
		Starts to understand time
		Remembers parts of a story
?	?	Understands the idea of "same" and "different"
		Plays board or card games

		Tells you what he thinks is going to happen next in a book
Language Milestones		
X	X	Knows some basic rules of grammar, such as correctly using “he” and “she”
?	?	Sings a song or says a poem from memory such as the “Itsy Bitsy Spider” or the “Wheels on the Bus”
		Tells stories
?	?	Can say first and last name
Social and Emotional Milestones		
X	X	Wants to please friends
?	X	Wants to be like friends
X	X	More likely to agree with rules
X	X	Likes to sing, dance, and act
?	?	Is aware of gender
X	X	Can tell what’s real and what’s make-believe
X	X	Shows more independence
X	X	Is sometimes demanding and sometimes very cooperative

5-Years-Old Checklist

Here are the milestones most children can do by 5 years of age

Cameron	Alexis	
Gross Motor		
		Stands on one foot for 10 seconds or longer
		Hops; may be able to skip
		Can do a somersault
?	?	Can use a toilet on her own
		Swings and climbs
Fine Motor		
?	?	Can draw a person with at least 6 body parts
?	?	Can print some letters or numbers
		Copies a triangle and geometric shapes
?	?	Uses a fork and spoon and sometimes a table knife
Cognitive Milestones		
?	?	Counts 10 or more things
?	?	Knows about things used every day, like money and food
Language Milestones		
X	X	Speaks very clearly
?	?	Tells a simple story using full sentences
?	?	Uses future tense; for example, “Grandma will be here.”
		Says name and address
Social and Emotional Milestones		
X	X	Wants to please friends
?	X	Wants to be like friends
X	X	More likely to agree with rules
X	X	Likes to sing, dance, and act
?	?	Is aware of gender
X	X	Can tell what’s real and what’s make-believe

		Shows more independence (for example, may visit a next-door neighbor by himself [adult supervision is still needed])
X	X	Is sometimes demanding and sometimes very cooperative

Step C: Summarize the Development Observed for Each Child

Using the milestones you were able to check off and what you have learned about development in Chapters 7-9 that might not be represented in the selected milestones, summarize what you observed about each of these areas of development. Your summaries should be at least a paragraph long, address several milestones, *and* include information that you saw related to each domain that is not included in the milestone checklists.

Cameron's Developmental Summary	
Gross Motor Development (large movements of the arms, legs, head, and torso)	Cameron is able to crawl around quickly. He can presumably can walk, run, jump, and climb. He uses his arms in big, sweeping movements when playing with the lion and the plane.
Fine Motor Development (more exact movements of the feet, toes, hands, and fingers)	Cameron is able to build with far more than 6 blocks, even changing their orientation the blocks are laid to achieve a different look. He plays with toys such as a lion or plane and uses them to knock over blocks.
Cognitive Development (thinking and problem-solving)	Cameron is able to build complex towers with blocks, which shows that he has learned from trial and error how to build a more stable tower. He is able to sustain attention on a task and he can keep track of a lot of items at once in his play area.
Language Development (receptive and expressive communication)	Cameron is seen talking to his friend Alexis for the duration of the video. He uses her name and describes his actions to her during play. When he is given instructions by a caregiver to stop messing up her blocks, he listens. He is able to have a back and fourth conversation with her that is a few sentences long per topic.
Social and Emotional Development (interactions, social and self-awareness, expression of feelings, and self-control)	Cameron is seen engaging in cooperative play with Alexis. He shows a lack of self-awareness when using the lions and plane to knock over her blocks, ignores her requests for him to stop, and needs to be told to stop by an authority figure. Upon correction, he changes his play to be more cooperative than destructive, helping Alexis build the tower.

Alexis's Developmental Summary	
Gross Motor Development (large movements of the arms, legs, head, and torso)	Alexis is able to crawl quickly and use her arms to navigate the shelves around her. She has full control over her arms, legs, and head. He uses her arms to hold her block tower steady when Cameron tried to knock it over. She can presumably walk, run, jump, and climb. She uses her arm to stop Cameron from knocking over her tower with his plane.
Fine Motor Development (more exact movements of the feet, toes, hands, and fingers)	Alexis is able to use her hands and fingers to play with the toys in her play area. She demonstrates the ability to play with blocks by both stacking them into a tower and laying them side by side with each other. She uses her hand and fingers to grab Cameron's wrist to stop him from knocking over her tower with his airplane.
Cognitive Development (thinking and problem-solving)	Alexis is able to play with blocks by both stacking them and aligning them side by side. She is also able to fix her structures when they are knocked over by Cameron. She shows skill in problem solving by asking for help from her teacher when Cameron won't listen to her when she asks her to stop.
Language Development (receptive and expressive communication)	Alexis is able to converse with Cameron during play by describing what she is doing while she is doing it. She is able to have a back and forth conversation with Cameron that is a few sentences long per topic. She also is able to express displeasure with Cameron's actions clearly and is able ask the teacher for help.
Social and Emotional Development (interactions, social and self-awareness, expression of feelings, and self-control)	Alexis is able to express a wide variety of emotions both physically and verbally. She recognizes when Cameron is breaking the rules by knocking over her structures. She shows self-confidence both when she asks Cameron repeatedly to stop and when she asks her teacher for help. After each problem is resolved, she is able to go back to having fun playing with Cameron. She switches her play to be slightly more compatible with Cameron's tendency to knock things over.

Step D: Analyze a Specific Milestone

Choose one specific milestone you observed from any area of any checklist (for example, "More likely to agree with rules") to analyze a little more closely. Think about why this milestone is important enough to notice as well as things that may positively and negatively influence that milestone (for example, a positive influence on the example milestone might be that the child has caregivers that have helped them to understand why there are rules and limits).

What milestone did you choose?	More likely to agree with rules
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What domain is this milestone in?	Social & Emotional
Which checklist is this milestone in?	4 and 5
Why is this milestone important? (What does it show us about the child's development? What does it now allow the child to do? What is coming next?)	This milestone represents the development of several important social and emotional milestones. Assuming the rules the child is subjected to are made in the interest of safety and kindness, agreeing with those rules shows that a child's ego-centrism is decreasing and that they are considering the perspective of other people.
What is something that would support the development of this milestone? (Positive influence)	Setting rules and consequences that are reasonable, fair, and are made in the interest of that child's safety and the fostering of virtuous traits will help a child develop a sense of empathy and right and wrong. As the child reaches the age of reason, being able to explain why you set the rules you have when questioned about it will continue to support the development of this milestone.
What is something that could prevent, delay, or undermine the development of this milestone? (Negative influence)	An authoritarian parenting style may scare a child into obeying when they're young, but as they get older they may develop a resentment for the harsh rules imposed upon them and wish to break free from them.

Step E: Make a Connection to a Theory

Theories help guide us to understand children's growth and development. The key theories in Child Development were introduced in Chapter 1 and revisited in later chapters, where appropriate. Connect something you observed to a theory we have covered in class (for example, Vygotsky's theory is seen when an adult provides a scaffold that allows a child complete a task that they would not be able to accomplish independently)

What theory are you making a connection with?	Erikson's Psychosocial Theory
What Chapter is this theory discussed in?	Chapter 9
On what page is the theory discussed?	215
How does what you observed illustrate this theory? Be specific about what you observed and how it relates to the theory.	When observing Alexis, I noticed that she had confidence at pretty much every point in the video. She is able to play with a large number of blocks. When her play is disrupted by Cameron, she has the self-confidence to tell him to stop repeatedly and to ask an adult for help without any feelings of guilt or shame. She also takes initiative by adjusting her play to account for Cameron's pattern of knocking things over. Overall, it shows that Alexis has been allowed to explore without being overly controlled or criticized, which has lead to her having a positive self image and confidence in herself.

Part Two: Reflection

Reflect on this experience by answering each of the questions

How was this experience different than seeing these children in person? (Consider both benefits and drawbacks)	A benefit to the virtual observation is being able to cherry pick perfect moments in time to replay to your students. In a live observation, there is no guarantee the children will do or show what you want them to. A big drawback is that many of the milestones in the checklist were not able to be observed in the children. If I were there in person, I would be able to observe them walking, running, climbing, and other important milestones that I had to make assumptions about.
What do you still have questions about in terms of early childhood development? What else do you wish you could have seen in action?	I wish we has more time to dedicate to how society and community factor into a child's emotional development.
What parts of this observation were you most successful with? Looking at the rubric, what areas do you believe you will score exemplary or proficient? Why?	I think I was able to effectively connect Alexis' confidence with Erikson's Psychosocial Theory. As someone who has worked with kids their age, I found her self-confidence striking, and I think I am correct in my observations regarding initiative versus guilt.
What parts of this observation were more challenging for you? What can you do before your next observation to improve your performance in these areas?	I think my summaries could be worded better. Doing a practice observation before my next one could help me improve.

Evaluation Criteria

	Exemplary	Proficient	Emerging	Building
Checklists for Cameron	Identified almost all milestones with Xs and ?s in all domains in all three ages 7 points	Several milestones present in the video not identified on checklists 5-6½ points	Missing numerous milestones; missing domains and/or ages 1-4½ points	Missing completely 0 points
Checklists for Alexis	Identified almost all milestones with Xs and ?s in all domains in all three ages 7 points	Several milestones present in the video not identified on checklists 5-6½ points	Missing numerous milestones; missing domains and/or ages 1-4½ points	Missing completely 0 points
Development Summaries for Cameron	Provided accurate, thorough 1 paragraph summary addressing milestones and other content for all three	Summary mostly accurate or not quite thorough and/or only addresses milestones or other content	Summaries not thorough and/or not accurate; milestones not identified 1-4½ points	Missing 0 points

	domains 7 points	5-6½ points		
Development Summaries for Alexis	Provided accurate, thorough 1 paragraph summary addressing milestones and other content for all three domains 7 points	Summary mostly accurate or not quite thorough and/or only addresses milestones or other content 5-6½ points	Summaries not thorough and/or not accurate; milestones not identified 1-4½ points	Missing 0 points
Milestone Analysis	Specific milestone observed chosen; thorough explanation of importance and accurate and specific positive and negative influences identified 7 points	Specific milestone observed chosen, but explanation of importance could be more thorough or positive and negative influences could be more specific 5-6½ points	Did not choose a specific milestone, explanation wasn't accurate, and/or influences not accurate 1-4½ points	Missing 0 points
Theory Connection	Identified theory and clearly related it to what was observed; AND provided chapter and page number in book 7 points	Identified theory; missing chapter or page number; OR connection to what was observed could have been more thoroughly described 5-6½ points	Identified theory; missing chapter and page number; OR inaccurate or missing explanation of connection to what was observed 1-4½ points	Missing 0 points
Reflection	Fully addresses all questions providing a complete reflection of at least a paragraph 5 points	All questions are at least partially addressed 4-4½ points	Missing responses to some questions 1-3½ points	Missing 0 points
Format and spelling & grammar	Types into form with very few spelling and grammar errors 3 points	Typed into form with some spelling and grammar errors 1-2½ points	Did not use form (may be asked to resubmit) OR many errors 0-½ points	

Total Points Possible 50